

Security Policies – Theory and Practical

Task 1: Configure Password Policy

Question:

Open the Local Security Policy tool on Windows Server and configure a password policy that requires at least 8 characters, includes uppercase and lowercase letters, and enforces password changes every 45 days.

Steps:

1. Log in to **Windows Server** as Administrator.
2. Press **Windows + R**.
3. Type secpol.msc and press **Enter**.
4. Go to **Security Settings → Account Policies → Password Policy**.
5. Double-click **Minimum password length**.
6. Set the value to **8** and click **Apply → OK**.
7. Double-click **Password must meet complexity requirements**.
8. Select **Enabled** and click **Apply → OK**.
9. Double-click **Maximum password age**.
10. Set the value to **45 days** and click **Apply → OK**.

11. Verify that the configured values are displayed in the Password Policy section.
-

Task 2: Configure Account Lockout Policy

Question:

Set up an account lockout policy so that a user account is locked after 3 invalid login attempts and remains locked for 15 minutes.

Steps:

1. Open **Local Security Policy** by pressing **Windows + R**, typing secpol.msc, and pressing **Enter**.
 2. Go to **Security Settings → Account Policies → Account Lockout Policy**.
 3. Double-click **Account lockout threshold**.
 4. Enter **3 invalid login attempts** and click **Apply → OK**.
 5. Double-click **Account lockout duration**.
 6. Set it to **15 minutes** and click **Apply → OK**.
 7. If prompted for **Reset account lockout counter after**, set it to **15 minutes**.
 8. Verify all configured values.
-

Task 3: Configure Audit Log Settings

Question:

Enable and configure audit logging to track successful and failed logon attempts on the server.

Steps:

1. Open **Local Security Policy** using secpol.msc.
 2. Go to **Security Settings → Local Policies → Audit Policy**.
 3. Double-click **Audit logon events**.
 4. Select **Success** and **Failure**.
 5. Click **Apply → OK**.
 6. Open **Event Viewer** by pressing **Windows + R**, typing eventvwr.msc, and pressing **Enter**.
 7. Go to **Windows Logs → Security**.
 8. Verify that successful and failed logon events are being recorded.
-

Task 4: Harden Windows Server by Disabling Unnecessary Services

Question:

Disable at least two unnecessary services using the Services management console and explain why they were selected.

Steps:

1. Press **Windows + R**.
2. Type **services.msc** and press **Enter**.
3. Locate **Print Spooler**.
4. Right-click **Print Spooler** → **Properties**.
5. Click **Stop**.
6. Set **Startup type** to **Disabled**.
7. Click **Apply** → **OK**.
8. Locate **Remote Registry**.
9. Right-click **Remote Registry** → **Properties**.
10. Click **Stop**.
11. Set **Startup type** to **Disabled**.
12. Click **Apply** → **OK**.
13. Verify that both services show **Stopped** and **Disabled**.

Reason for selecting these services:

- **Print Spooler:** If the server does not provide printing services, disabling it reduces unnecessary services and potential attack surface.
- **Remote Registry:** If remote registry access is not required, disabling it prevents unnecessary remote access to the Windows Registry.

Note: Disable these services only if they are not required for your server's role or lab environment.

Task 5: Submit Security Policy Report

Question:

Prepare a 1–2 page report describing the configured security policies, including screenshots of the password policy, account lockout policy, and audit log settings.

Steps:

1. Capture a screenshot of the **Password Policy** settings.
2. Capture a screenshot of the **Account Lockout Policy** settings.
3. Capture a screenshot of the **Audit Logon Events** settings.
4. Capture a screenshot of the **Services** console showing the disabled services.

5. Add the screenshots to the report.
6. Briefly explain how each security policy improves server security.
7. Save the report as a **PDF or DOCX** file.
8. Submit the completed report

Policy	Configuration	Security Benefit
Password Policy	Minimum 8 characters, complexity enabled, maximum age 45 days	Prevents weak and old passwords
Account Lockout	3 invalid attempts, 15-minute lockout	Helps prevent brute-force attacks
Audit Logon Events	Success and Failure enabled	Tracks login activity
Print Spooler	Disabled if not required	Reduces unnecessary attack surface
Remote Registry	Disabled if not required	Reduces unnecessary remote access